

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1304

By Eldridge

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Kaycee Mae Pratt, 2026 Grainger High School graduate, on her acceptance to Vanderbilt University.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to pay tribute to those students who, through their natural talents and unflagging commitment to academic excellence, have distinguished themselves in the classroom; and

WHEREAS, Kaycee Mae Pratt is one such exceptional student, who was recently accepted to Vanderbilt University as a member of the Class of 2030; and

WHEREAS, through diligent study, steady composure during examinations, and steadfast commitment of time and talent, Ms. Pratt has achieved outstanding success in her academic career and her philanthropic endeavors; she is slated to graduate from Grainger High School in May 2026 and will be a leader in STEM and first-generation college student; and

WHEREAS, in her remarkable high school career, Kaycee Pratt has earned an exemplary grade point average of 5.0, excelling in dual enrollment courses at Walters State Community College, where she is a member of the Phi Theta Kappa Honor Society; and

WHEREAS, she has participated in numerous extracurricular activities, including Club America and the National Society of High School Scholars; she serves the Beta Club as vice president, the varsity cheer team as captain, and the Knoxville Teen Board as a presenter; and

WHEREAS, a leader among her peers, Ms. Pratt is an Algebra I tutor and has further devoted her time and talents as a volunteer for the office of State Representative Rick Eldridge; and

WHEREAS, Kaycee Pratt has completed more than 1,000 service hours and accumulated more than \$20,000 in philanthropic contributions, which she donated to community outreach initiatives and national nonprofit organizations; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Pratt is the founder and director of Kaycee's CandyLab, a nonprofit organization that, since 2022, has partnered with regional schools and community programs and collectively served more than 12,500 military children throughout Tennessee, North Carolina, and California; and

WHEREAS, her philanthropic service also includes work with Grainger County and Blaine Police departments and Blount County EMS, providing moral support and offering donations; local schools, supporting morale-building efforts, cheer teams, and philanthropy programs; the WOW Fair, where she is a STEM presenter; the Susan G. Komen Foundation as a fundraiser; the towns of Burnsville, North Carolina, and Erwin, providing relief for Hurricane Helene victims; and Second Harvest Food Bank of East Tennessee, among many others, further demonstrating her commitment to civic service and the well-being of her community; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to awards and accolades, Ms. Pratt was duly recognized for her exceptional leadership with the 2026 Tennessee Governor's Volunteer Stars Award, the 2026 Congressional Medal of Honor for Youth Service, and the Congressional Award Bronze Medal; she was also featured in the *Citizen Tribune*, *Grainger County Journal*, and *Knoxville News Sentinel*; and

WHEREAS, Kaycee Pratt's display of intellectual aptitude and ambition surely bodes well for her future success at Vanderbilt University; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Pratt's noteworthy achievements are a tremendous source of pride for her family, her school, and her community; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Pratt's dedication to excellence is clearly deserving of the respect, admiration, and commendation of the members of this General Assembly; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Kaycee Mae Pratt, 2026 Grainger High School

graduate, on her impressive academic achievements and acceptance to Vanderbilt University, extending to her our best wishes for continued success and happiness in her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.